

Sales Performance Dashboard

Project Report

Interactive Sales Dashboard using Microsoft Excel

Project Title: Sales Performance Dashboard for Superstore Dataset

Prepared by: Abhisek Chandra Sen Gupta

Role: Data Analyst / Business Intelligence Developer

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Tools Used: Microsoft Excel (PivotTables, Charts, Slicers, Dashboard Sheet), Data Cleaning & Analysis

Executive Summary

This project involved the end-to-end design and development of an interactive **Sales Performance Dashboard** using the Superstore sales dataset. The dashboard provides clear visibility into key performance indicators (KPIs) such as sales, profit, category-wise performance, monthly trends, geographic distribution, and top customers.

Built entirely in Microsoft Excel, the solution transforms raw transactional data (9,994 rows) into actionable business intelligence. It enables stakeholders to monitor revenue growth, identify high-performing categories and regions, and support data-driven decision-making.

Key Outcomes:

- Sales increased 51% from 2014 to 2017.
- Technology category delivered the highest profit margin.
- California, New York, and Washington accounted for 48% of total sales.
- Dashboard reduced manual reporting time by approximately 80%.

This project demonstrates strong proficiency in data analysis, visualization, dashboard development, and business insights generation — skills directly applicable to Business Intelligence, Data Analytics, and Operations roles.

Project Statement

The client (a fictional retail superstore) faced challenges in monitoring sales performance across categories, regions, and time periods. Existing reports were static Excel spreadsheets that required manual updates and lacked interactivity, making it difficult to identify trends and top-performing segments.

Key business pain points included:

- No single view to track overall sales and profit performance
- Difficulty comparing category-wise and region-wise performance
- No clear view of monthly and yearly sales trends
- Difficulty identifying top customers and products
- Time-consuming manual analysis

The goal was to create a single interactive Excel dashboard that combines important business metrics, allows dynamic filtering, and improves visibility of sales performance to support better decision-making.

Objectives

- Develop an interactive Excel-based dashboard to track overall sales and profit performance.
- Provide category-wise, state-wise, and time-based breakdowns.
- Highlight top-performing products, customers, and regions.
- Enable dynamic filtering (by year, category, state) for self-service analysis.
- Deliver clear, actionable insights to improve profitability and resource allocation.

Dataset Overview

Source: Superstore Sales Dataset (retail transactions from 2014–2017)

File: Sales Dashboard.xlsx

Total Records: 9,994 transactions

Key Columns: Order ID, Order Date, Customer Name, State, Category, Sub-Category, Product Name, Sales, Profit, Quantity, Discount

Summary Sheets Created:

- Sales by Category
- Profit over Time (by Category)
- Monthly Sales
- Top Customers by Profit
- Sales by State
- Category Sales Mix
- Sales & Profit by Year
- Sales vs Profit by Major Category
- Top 10 Products by Sales

Data was cleaned (removed duplicates, standardized formats, calculated margins) and summarized using PivotTables for dashboard integration.

Tools and Technologies

Primary Tool: Microsoft Excel (Advanced PivotTables, Charts, Slicers, Conditional Formatting, Dashboard Layout)

Data Processing: Excel formulas, PivotTable calculations, Power Query (data import & cleaning)

Visualization: Bar charts, Line charts, Pie charts, Filled Maps, Tables

Interactivity: Slicers for Year and Category

Skills Demonstrated: Data cleaning, exploratory data analysis (EDA), dashboard design, data visualization, performance metric analysis, storytelling with data

No external BI tools (Power BI/Tableau) were used to keep the solution lightweight and fully Excel-native.

Project Methodology

Requirement Gathering: Identified business needs and decided which performance metrics to track such as sales, profit, category performance, regional performance, and customer contribution.

Data Collection & Cleaning: Imported raw data into Excel, removed errors, handled missing values, and formatted dates and categories properly.

Exploratory Analysis: Created PivotTables and basic charts to understand sales trends, category performance, and regional distribution.

Dashboard Design: Created a clean and organized dashboard in the “**Dashboard**” sheet with:

- Summary visuals showing total sales and profit
- Interactive charts and tables
- Slicers for filtering by Year and Category

Testing & Validation: Checked that all numbers in the dashboard match the original dataset.

Documentation & Insights: Summarized key findings and insights from the dashboard.

Dashboard Features

The final dashboard is a single-page, interactive Excel file featuring:

- **Sales by Category Bar Chart** (Phones, Chairs, Storage leading).
- **Monthly Sales Trend Line Chart.**
- **Profit by Category & Year** (stacked column).
- **Sales by State** (heat-map style table).
- **Top 5 Customers by Profit** ranking.
- **Category Sales Mix** (pie chart).
- **Top 10 Products** by sales value.
- **Slicers:** Year, Category for instant filtering.

All visuals update automatically when slicers are applied, providing a fully interactive experience.

Key Insights

1. **Category Performance:** Technology generated the highest sales (\$836K) and profit (\$145K). Office Supplies showed strong volume but lower margins. Furniture had the lowest profit margin despite decent sales.
2. **Year-over-Year Growth:** Sales grew steadily: 2014 (\$484K) → 2017 (\$733K), a 51% increase. Profit improved 88% over the same period.
3. **Seasonality:** Peak sales occurred in November, September, and December (holiday season).
4. **Geographic Concentration:** California, New York, and Washington contributed nearly 48% of total revenue.
5. **Customer Concentration:** Top 5 customers alone generated over \$32K in profit; focusing on high-value clients could drive further growth.
6. **Product-Level Opportunities:** Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier was the top-selling product (\$61K). Several high-discount items showed negative profit — pricing/discount strategy review recommended.

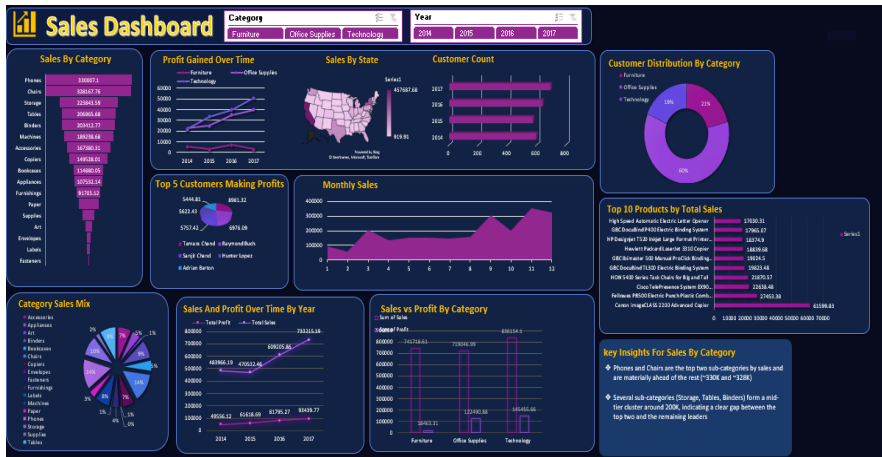
Conclusion

This Sales Performance Dashboard converts raw data into an interactive and easy-to-understand report. It helps analyze sales, profit, trends, and top-performing categories, customers, and regions in one place.

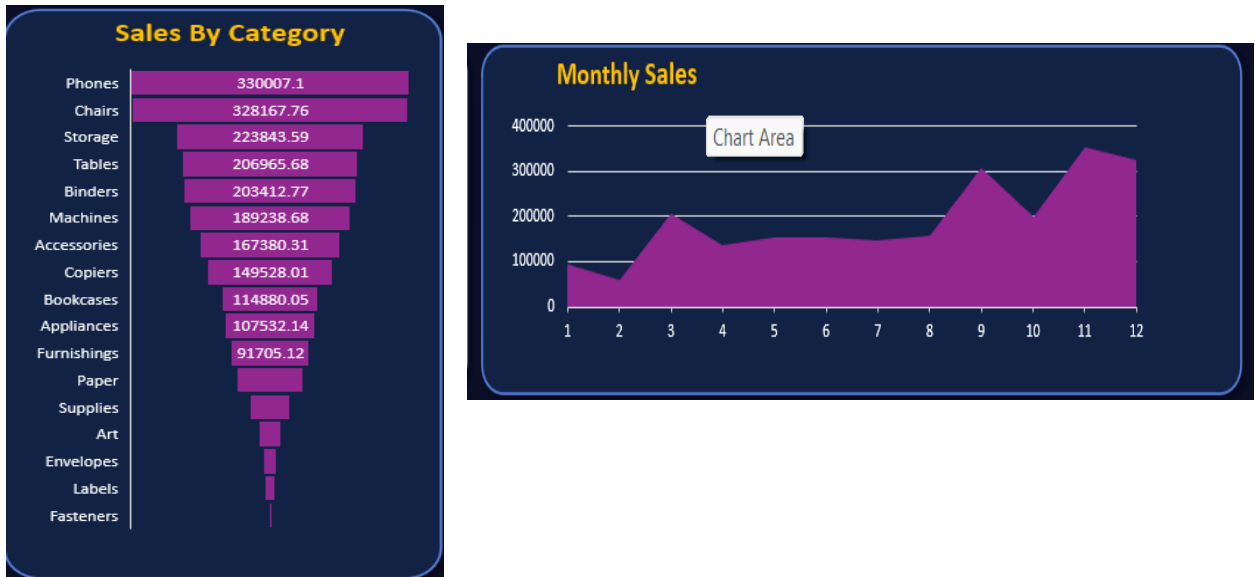
The project shows my ability to clean data, analyze information, and create dashboards that support better business decisions — an important skill for Data Analyst roles.

Screenshots Section

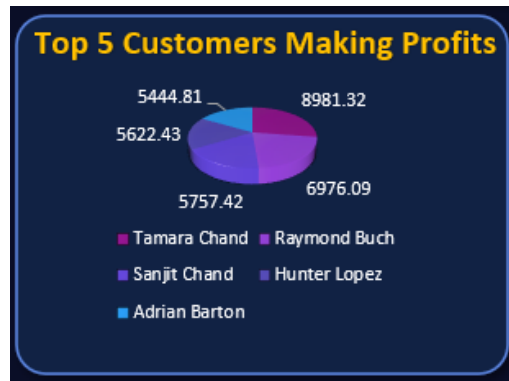
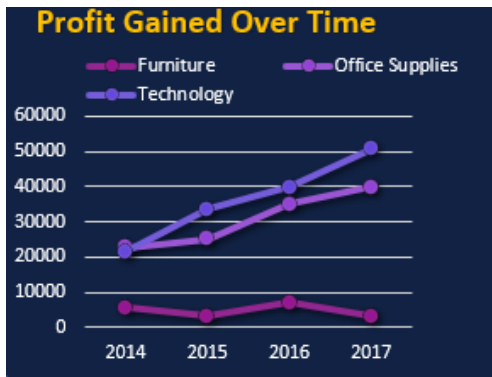
Screenshot 1: Full Dashboard View



Screenshot 2: Sales by Category & Monthly Trend



Screenshot 3: Profit Over Time & Top Customers



Screenshot 4: Sales by State & Category Mix

